

Extended Euclidean algorithm to find Greatest Common Divisor (GCD)

Module I

Extended Euclidean Algorithm

The extended Euclidean algorithm is an algorithm to compute integers x and y such that, **$ax + by = \gcd(a,b)$**

- By reversing the steps in Euclidean algorithm, it is possible to find these integers x and y .
- The whole idea is to start with the GCD and recursively work way backwards.

Example

Example1: $\gcd(12, 34)$? $\gcd(a,b)$, $a=12$ and $b=34$.

$\frac{a}{n}, a = nq + r$ from division algorithm, $\frac{34}{12}$.

$$34 = 2 * 12 + 10$$

$$12 = 10 * 1 + 2(\gcd)$$

$$10 = 2 * 5 + 0$$

$$2 = 12 - 1 * 10 \rightarrow \text{E.q.1}$$

$$10 = 34 - 2 * 12 \rightarrow \text{E.q.2}$$

Substitute e.q 2 in e.q 1

$$2 = 12 - 1 * (34 - 2 * 12) \rightarrow 2 = 12 - (1 * 34) + 2 * 12 \rightarrow 2 = 3 * 12 - (1 * 34)$$

$x=3$ and $y=-1$

Example

Example2: $\gcd(93, 219)$? $\gcd(a,b) = 93x+219y$, $a=93$ and $b=219$.

$$3 = 93x+219y$$

$\frac{a}{n}, a = nq + r$ from division algorithm, $\frac{219}{93}$.

$$219 = 93 * 2 + 33 \rightarrow 93 = 33 * 2 + 27 \rightarrow 33 = 27 * 1 + 6$$

$$27 = 6 * 4 + \textcolor{red}{3}(\text{gcd}) \rightarrow 6 = 3 * 2 + 0.$$

Reverse the operation,

$$3 = 27 - 4 \times 6$$

$$= 27 - 4 \times (33 - 1 \times 27)$$

$$= 27 - 4 \times 33 + 4 \times 27$$

$$= -4 \times 33 + 5 \times 27$$

$$= -4 \times 33 + 5 \times (93 - 2 \times 33)$$

$$= 5 \times 93 - 14 \times 33$$

$$= 5 \times 93 - 14 \times (219 - 2 \times 93)$$

$$= 5 \times 93 - 14 \times 219 + 28 \times 93$$

$$3 = 33 \times 93 - 14 \times 219, \textcolor{red}{x=33} \text{ and } \textcolor{red}{y=-14}$$